

Teacher Guide — middle / module-03-ayurveda-good-health

IKS Curriculum

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Overview

Module 3 — Ayurveda and Good Health

Age band: Middle · **Grades:** 6–8 · **Duration:** 10 sessions × 45 min

Learning objectives

By the end of this module, students will be able to:

1. **Define** *Āyurveda* (literally “science of life”) and *Swasthya* (wellbeing, including physical, mental, and social dimensions).
2. **Name** the three doshas (*Vāta*, *Pitta*, *Kapha*) with their elemental basis, qualities, and observable signs.
3. **Recall** the components of *Dinacharya* (daily routine) — waking, oral hygiene, oil massage, exercise, meals, sleep — and articulate the principle behind each.
4. **Quote** at least one primary source verse (Bhagavad-gītā 6.17 on regulated lifestyle) in IAST with translation.
5. **Apply** the framework: design a 1-week dinacharya for themselves with rationale.
6. **Distinguish** Ayurveda’s domain (lifestyle, prevention, chronic care, herbal pharmacology) from modern allopathic medicine’s domain (acute care, surgery, infectious disease), articulating where they’re complementary and where they’re not equivalent.

NEP 2020 alignment

- §4.6 — IKS integration
- §4.31 — Physical fitness and well-being
- §11.8 — Multidisciplinary (Ayurveda + biology + lifestyle science)

Prerequisites

- Familiarity with the five elements (Module 2 — Panchabhuta — recommended).
- Basic biology of digestion, sleep, exercise from school science.

Key vocabulary

- *Āyurveda* — “science of life”
- *Swasthya* — wellbeing (literally “self-established”)
- *Dosha* — humour, biological energy
- *Vāta, Pitta, Kapha* — the three doshas
- *Dinacharya* — daily routine
- *Ritucharya* — seasonal routine
- *Ahāra* — food
- *Vihāra* — recreation, lifestyle

Materials checklist

- Wall poster of the 3 doshas with elements + qualities
- Printed extract: BG 6.17 + translation
- Self-assessment worksheet (Day 3) — for fun, not diagnosis
- Sample herbs (tulsi, ginger — if no allergies)

Day-by-day overview

Day	Title	Focus
1	What is Ayurveda? + Swasthya	Definition + scope
2	The Tridosha	Vāta, Pitta, Kapha intro
3	Self-assessment (with caveats)	Which dosha “tilts” your life?
4	Dinacharya	The daily routine
5	Mid-module check + project	Formative + topic
6	Ahāra — food	Six tastes; what to eat when
7	BG 6.17 primary source	<i>yuktāhāra-vihārasya</i> — regulated life
8	Project Session 1	Design your dinacharya
9	Project Session 2	Refine
10	Final + presentation	Summative + present your dinacharya

Citation sources

- vidya-karana RAG: BG 6.17 (regulated lifestyle), supporting Bhagavatam chunks
- Caraka Saṃhitā for teacher reference (Wujastyk 2003)

Project brief

Each student designs a 7-day dinacharya (daily routine) for themselves, with one line per item explaining the Ayurvedic principle behind it. Presented Day 10. Full brief in [assessments/project-brief.md](#).

Safety note

Ayurveda is not magic. Students with medical conditions (asthma, allergies, diabetes, etc.) should NOT change their existing care based on this module. The module teaches the framework; medical decisions belong with a qualified physician.

10-Day Lesson Plan

Module 3 (Middle) — 10-Day Lesson Plan

Day	Title	File
1	What is Ayurveda?	days/day-01-hook.md
2	The Tridosha	days/day-02-tridosha.md
3	Self-assessment	days/day-03-self-assessment.md
4	Dinacharya	days/day-04-dinacharya.md
5	Mid-module + project	days/day-05-mid-module.md
6	Ahāra — food	days/day-06-ahara.md
7	BG 6.17 primary source	days/day-07-primary-source.md
8	Project Session 1	days/day-08-project-session-1.md
9	Project Session 2	days/day-09-project-session-2.md
10	Final + presentation	days/day-10-final-assessment.md

Pacing

- Day 3 self-assessment is FOR FUN, not diagnostic. State this firmly.
- Day 4 dinacharya is the most practical session — protect time.
- Day 10 needs ~4 min per student presenting their dinacharya.

Daily warm-up

Each class opens with: “Which dosha did you notice most yesterday?” (mood/energy/food/sleep observation). 2 students share.

What students leave with

- Vocabulary: Ayurveda, Swasthya, dosha, dinacharya.
- The Tridosha framework with examples.
- A personal 7-day dinacharya.
- BG 6.17 in IAST + translation.
- The discipline of distinguishing lifestyle medicine from acute medicine.

Teacher Notes

Teacher Notes — Module 3 (Middle)

Posture

The honest framing:

Ayurveda is a real, ancient, sophisticated framework of lifestyle medicine. It is well-suited for: prevention, chronic conditions, daily wellbeing, dietary guidance. It is NOT a substitute for modern medicine for: acute illness, infections, surgery, life-threatening conditions.

The “both/and” framing is critical. We are NOT teaching that Ayurveda replaces modern medicine. We ARE teaching that the Ayurvedic framework has real wisdom about sleep, food, daily rhythms, and that modern medicine increasingly validates many of these (circadian biology, gut microbiome, sleep science).

Hard rule — never teach as medical advice

The Day 3 self-assessment is **fun and educational**, NOT diagnostic. Make this explicit: - “This is not a doctor’s diagnosis.” - “If you are unwell, see a qualified physician.” - “Some students take medications; nothing in this module changes that.”

If a student says “but I think I have a Pitta imbalance” — gently redirect: “the framework is interesting; if you have actual health concerns, talk to a doctor.”

Common misconceptions

1. **“Ayurveda doesn’t work.”** False at the population-medicine level. Many Ayurvedic herbs (turmeric, ashwagandha, neem) have modern evidence. Many dinacharya practices (regular sleep, balanced meals, oil massage) align with modern lifestyle medicine.
2. **“Ayurveda works for everything.”** False at the acute-care level. If you have pneumonia, you need antibiotics, not turmeric.

3. **“Dosha types are scientifically validated.”** Mixed evidence. The tridosha framework is best understood as a *typology of tendency*, not a strict biomedical classification. Some studies show correlates; many do not.
4. **“Sushruta did rhinoplasty.”** True. Documented in Suśruta Saṃhitā. European surgeons learned the technique via 18th-c. Bengali practitioners. (This is a Module 1 fact; reinforces Ayurveda’s scope.)

On the religious dimension

Ayurveda has theological associations (Dhanvantari, the deity of Ayurveda; the Caraka Saṃhitā’s invocations). The classroom frame: respect the tradition’s religious dimensions, focus on the lifestyle and pharmacological insights, don’t conflate.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Read excerpts from Caraka Saṃhitā chapter on dinacharya.
- **Tier down:** Focus on Vāta-Pitta-Kapha + 3 dinacharya practices.

Project oversight

- The 7-day dinacharya project is personal. Students should NOT share specifics they’re uncomfortable with.
- Strong projects have *realistic* schedules (not “wake at 4am every day if you’ve never done this”).

If you only have 6 days

- Day 1: Ayurveda + Swasthya
- Day 2: Tridosha
- Day 3: Dinacharya
- Day 4: Ahāra + BG 6.17
- Day 5: Project session
- Day 6: Presentations + summative

Sources

Sources — Module 3 (Middle)

Primary sources (from RAG)

- **Bhagavad-gītā 6.17** — *yuktāhāra-vihārasya yukta-ceṣṭasya karmasu yukta-svapnāvabodhasya yogo bhavati duḥkha-hā* — “He who is regulated in eating, recreation, work, sleep, and waking can mitigate sorrow.”

This verse is the philosophical anchor for the dinacharya framework. Cached in `.rag-cache/day-04-dinacharya.json`.

- Supporting Bhāgavatam and Prabhupāda commentary chunks in `.rag-cache/day-01-intro.json`.

Scholarly secondary

- **Wujastyk, D. (2003).** *The Roots of Ayurveda*. Penguin. — Accessible primary-source translations of Caraka, Suśruta, Aṣṭāṅga Hṛdaya excerpts.
- **Smith, F. M. (2006).** *The Self Possessed: Deity and Spirit Possession in South Asian Literature and Civilization*. Columbia. — Broader cultural-historical context.

Classical primary (for teacher reference)

- **Caraka Saṃhitā** (~2nd c. BCE) — Sharma (1981) translation.
- **Suśruta Saṃhitā** — Sushruta’s surgical procedures.
- **Aṣṭāṅga Hṛdaya** by Vāgbhaṭa (~7th c. CE) — standard classical Ayurvedic textbook.

Modern medical perspective

- Patwardhan, B., Mutalik, G., & Tillu, G. (2015). *Integrative Approaches for Health: Biomedical Research, Ayurveda and Yoga*. Academic Press. — Engages the modern-evidence question seriously.

Citation discipline

A strong Middle-band project cites at least one source. Acceptable: the BG 6.17 verse from the RAG cache, OR a citation from Wujastyk, OR an NCERT Health & Physical Education chapter.

Day 1 — What is Ayurveda? + Swasthya

Module: Ayurveda (Middle) · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

Students define *Āyurveda* and *Swasthya* and articulate the scope of the framework (lifestyle, prevention, herbal medicine — not surgery or acute care).

Materials

- Whiteboard
- A few sample herbs (turmeric, tulsi if available — check allergies)

Flow

Warm-up (5 min)

Provocation: “If someone said to you ‘what is Ayurveda?’, what would you say in one sentence?”

Take 3 student answers.

Core (25 min)

1. **Etymology:** *āyu* (life, vitality) + *veda* (knowledge, science) = “**the science of life.**” Not just illness — the entire life.
2. **Swasthya** — *swa* (self) + *stha* (established) = “**self-established / situated in oneself.**” A working definition of wellbeing: physical + mental + social balance.
3. **What Ayurveda covers:**
 - Daily routine (*dinacharya*)
 - Seasonal routine (*ritucharya*)
 - Food (*ahāra*) — what, when, how to eat
 - Recreation (*vihāra*) — exercise, sleep, social life
 - Herbal medicines (*aushadhi*)
 - Surgery (*śalya-tantra*) — historically, e.g. Sushruta
 - 8 branches total (the *aṣṭāṅga* of Ayurveda)
4. **What Ayurveda does NOT cover well:**
 - Acute infections requiring antibiotics
 - Emergency surgery
 - Genetic conditions requiring modern diagnostics
 - Mental health requiring specialised psychiatric care
5. **The honest framing:** Ayurveda + modern medicine are *partners*, not rivals. Each has a domain. Don’t substitute one for the other.

Activity (10 min) — Map a day

Students fold paper in 4. Label each quadrant: *Sleep, Food, Exercise, Mood*. In each, write what they did yesterday.

Note: “*This is your raw data. Over the next 2 weeks we’ll learn the Ayurvedic framework to make sense of it.*”

Wrap-up (5 min)

- Preview Day 2: “*Tomorrow — the Tridosha. Three biological energies.*”

Homework

- Notice tonight: what time do you go to sleep? What did you eat for dinner? How did you feel after?

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Read Wujastyk’s intro chapter.
- **Tier down:** Just memorise *Āyurveda* (science of life) and *Swasthya* (wellbeing).

Teacher notes

- The “8 branches” detail is for students who want depth. At Middle band, the 6 mentioned items are enough.
- Watch for students with health conditions — don’t single them out or imply Ayurveda is for them.

Citation(s) used

- vidya-karana RAG cache day-01-intro.json for general Ayurveda framing.
- Wujastyk (2003) for scope.

Day 2 — The Tridosha

Module: Ayurveda (Middle) · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

Students name the three doshas, their elemental basis, characteristic qualities, and one observable sign of each.

Materials

- Wall chart of the 3 doshas
- Whiteboard

Vocabulary

- *dosha* — humour, biological energy
- *Vāta* — wind/space dosha
- *Pitta* — fire/water dosha
- *Kapha* — water/earth dosha

Flow

Warm-up (5 min)

Daily prompt + recall: define Āyurveda and Swasthya.

Core (25 min)

1. Build the dosha table on the board:

Dosha	Elements	Qualities	Function	When out of balance
Vāta	air + space	mobile, dry, light, cold, rough	Movement, breath, nervous system	Anxiety, insomnia, dry skin, constipation
Pitta	fire + water	hot, sharp,	Digestion,	Heartburn, irritability, skin

Dosha	Elements	Qualities	Function	When out of balance
		light, oily, slightly liquid	metabolism, vision	inflammation
Kapha	water + earth	heavy, slow, cool, oily, smooth	Structure, immunity, lubrication	Lethargy, congestion, weight gain

2. **Note the connection to Module 2.** The doshas are built from the *pañcabhūta* (five elements). Each dosha is a particular combination of elements + qualities.
3. **Important framing: Everyone has all three doshas.** Your *prakṛti* (constitution) is the proportion you're born with. Your *vikṛti* (current state) is your present balance.
4. **Where modern medicine agrees, where it doesn't:**
 - Modern lifestyle medicine: agrees on regular sleep, balanced meals, moderate exercise.
 - Modern circadian biology: agrees on aligning daily activities with body rhythms.
 - Modern dosha-as-biomedical-category: **mixed evidence**. Some studies show correlates with body type and metabolism; others don't.

Activity (10 min) — Sign spotting

Students think of one person they know (not themselves). Write 3 observable traits. Try to match to a dosha tilt.

(Stress: NOT diagnostic. Just practice with the framework.)

Wrap-up (5 min)

- Preview Day 3: “*Tomorrow — your own self-assessment. With caveats.*”

Homework

- Notice tonight: what did you eat? When? How did you feel after? Take notes.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Read the Caraka Saṃhitā chapter on dosha (in Wujastyk 2003).
- **Tier down:** Memorise just: Vāta (air+space, movement), Pitta (fire+water, digestion), Kapha (water+earth, structure).

Teacher notes

- Don't push students to “find their type.” The framework is interesting; over-typing is not.
- The “everyone has all three” point is critical. Resist the pop-Ayurveda “you ARE Vāta” framing.

Citation(s) used

- vidya-karana RAG cache day-02-tridosha.json.

- Wujastyk (2003) for classical Tridosha exposition.

Day 3 — Self-Assessment (with Caveats)

Module: Ayurveda (Middle) · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

Students apply the dosha framework to themselves via a self-assessment worksheet, while understanding firmly that it is for fun and learning, not medical diagnosis.

Materials

- Self-assessment worksheet (12 questions)

Flow

Warm-up (5 min)

Daily prompt + recall: 3 doshas with one quality each.

The disclaimer (5 min) — TEACHER FRAMING IS CRITICAL

Write on board:

TODAY’S QUIZ IS NOT A DIAGNOSIS.

It’s a way to practise the framework.

If you have any health concerns, see a doctor.

Everyone has all three doshas.

Make the class chorus this last line out loud.

Self-assessment (15 min)

Hand out worksheet (sample below). Students answer honestly. Tally V / P / K.

Worksheet (12 questions, 3 each per dosha)

For each, circle the option closest to you:

#	Question	V	P	K
1	Build	thin, light	medium	sturdy, heavier
2	Skin	dry, cool	warm, sensitive	smooth, oily
3	Energy	bursts and lulls	strong and focused	steady, slow
4	Hunger	irregular	strong,	mild, can

#	Question	V	P	K
5	Sleep	light, easily disturbed	can't skip sound, normal	skip deep, long
6	Speech	fast, talkative	sharp, persuasive	slow, calm
7	Memory	quick to learn, quick to forget	sharp, decisive	slow, lasting
8	Stress	anxious, worried	irritable, frustrated	withdrawn , slow
9	Weather preferred	warm	cool	warm and dry
10	Walking	fast	medium	slow
11	Hands & feet	cold	warm	cool, moist
12	Spending	impulsive	calculated	careful, saver

Total: V = , P = , K = ____

The largest score = your *current* dosha tilt. Note: this is a snapshot, not your identity.

Discussion (15 min)

- Share-of-hands: how many are predominantly Vāta? Pitta? Kapha? Mixed?
- Reinforce: “*This is a tendency observation, not a verdict.*”
- Discuss: did anyone get a result that surprised them?

Wrap-up (5 min)

- Preview Day 4: “*Tomorrow — Dinacharya. The daily routine that tradition recommends for keeping all three doshas in balance.*”

Homework

- Look up ONE Ayurvedic recommendation for your dominant dosha (food, sleep timing, type of exercise). Bring tomorrow.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Notice your result; do you AGREE? If not, why might the framework miss?
- **Tier down:** Focus on Q1–6; skip Q7–12.

Teacher notes

- Some students will be deeply invested in “their type.” Gently redirect: “*It’s a tool, not a label.*”
- The framework correlates loosely with body-type psychology (Sheldon’s somatotypes, for example). Senior students engage this comparison.

Citation(s) used

- Self-assessment adapted from standard Ayurveda introductory texts (Wujastyk 2003; various modern Ayurveda primers).

Day 4 — Dinacharya (Daily Routine)

Module: Ayurveda (Middle) · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

Students recall the components of *dinacharya* (waking, oral hygiene, oil massage, exercise, meals, sleep) and articulate the principle behind each.

Materials

- Wall chart of dinacharya timeline
- Whiteboard

Vocabulary

- *Dinacharya* — daily routine (literally “day’s conduct”)
- *Brāhma muhūrta* — “Brahma’s hour,” ~96 min before sunrise (recommended wake time, traditionally)
- *Abhyanga* — oil self-massage
- *Vyāyāma* — exercise

Flow

Warm-up (5 min)

Daily prompt + recall: dosha balance principle from yesterday.

Core (25 min)

1. **The dinacharya timeline** (build on the board, in order):

Time	Practice	Why
Brāhma muhūrta (before sunrise)	Wake	Body’s natural alertness peak
Just after waking	Drink warm water	Stimulates digestion, aids

Time	Practice	Why
		elimination
Morning	Oral hygiene (tongue scraping, oil pulling)	Removes overnight buildup
Pre-bath	Abhyanga (warm oil self-massage)	Calms Vāta; nourishes skin
Morning	Exercise (vyāyāma) — up to 50% capacity	Builds Pitta; doesn't deplete
Mid-morning	Largest meal of the day	Digestive fire (Pitta) is strongest
Evening	Light dinner, before sunset (ideally)	Aligns with digestive rhythm
Night	Sleep by 10pm	Aligns with Kapha → Pitta night cycle

2. **The principle:** the day is divided into Kapha (6am–10am), Pitta (10am–2pm), Vāta (2pm–6pm), then repeating. Each time block has dominant dosha character. Activities aligned with the block work with the body, not against it.

3. **Modern science overlap:**

- **Circadian biology** (Aschoff 1965, Nobel Prize 2017 to Hall, Rosbash, Young) — confirms ~24-hour rhythms in metabolism, hormones, sleep.
- **Time-restricted eating** (Satchidananda Panda's work) — confirms larger meal earlier is metabolically better.
- **Sleep science** — confirms sleeping by ~10pm aligns with melatonin curve.
- **Oil massage** — emerging evidence on skin barrier, lymphatic drainage.

4. **The honest framing:** Many dinacharya practices align with modern lifestyle medicine. The framework was figured out from observation centuries before modern measurement.

Read primary source (5 min)

BG 6.17: > *yuktāhāra-vihārasya yukta-ceṣṭasya karmasu* > *yukta-svapnāvabodhasya yogo bhavati duḥkha-hā*

“He who is regulated in eating, recreation, work, sleep, and waking can mitigate sorrow.”

(Read aloud once. Won't fully analyse today — that's Day 7.)

Activity (8 min) — Map your dinacharya

Each student writes their CURRENT daily routine in the dinacharya timeline format. Notice where it aligns and where it doesn't.

Wrap-up (2 min)

- Preview Day 5: “Tomorrow — mid-module check + project topic.”

Homework

- Pick ONE dinacharya practice you don't currently do. Try it tomorrow. Note how it felt.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Read about Panda's time-restricted eating research. Note overlap with dinacharya meal timing.
- **Tier down:** Focus on 3 practices: wake with sun, eat largest meal mid-morning, sleep by 10pm.

Teacher notes

- The "brāhma muhūrta wake time" is *traditionally* recommended but unrealistic for many students. Don't push.
- The science overlap is real; don't oversell ("Ayurveda predicted everything"). The honest framing: "tradition observed; science measured; they agree on much."

Citation(s) used

- BG 6.17 — vidya-karana RAG cache day-04-dinacharya.json#chunks[0].
- Panda, S. (2018). *The Circadian Code*. Rodale. (Modern alignment.)

Day 5 — Mid-Module Check + Project

Module: Ayurveda (Middle) · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

Students consolidate Days 1–4 + commit to project (their 7-day dinacharya design).

Materials

- Formative quiz Part B
- Project brief

Flow

Warm-up (3 min)

Daily prompt.

Formative quiz (15 min)

quizzes/formative.md Part B. Closed notebook.

Review (10 min)

Walk through quiz; common errors.

Project commitment (15 min)

Hand out project brief.

Each student decides: - Target audience for their dinacharya (themselves, a sibling, a parent, a peer with a busy schedule). - Realistic time slots. - One specific practice they're committing to from each block: morning, midday, evening, night.

Submit project plan paragraph.

Wrap-up (2 min)

- Preview Day 6: "*Tomorrow — ahāra. Food.*"

Homework

- Submit project plan paragraph.

Day 6 — Ahāra (Food)

Module: Ayurveda (Middle) · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

Students name the six tastes (*rasa*) in Ayurveda, the recommended meal-timing principle, and one food pairing tradition recommends avoiding.

Materials

- 6 taste samples if available (salt for salty, lemon for sour, jaggery for sweet, mint for bitter, ginger for pungent, raw banana or persimmon for astringent)
- Whiteboard

Vocabulary

- *Ahāra* — food
- *Rasa* — taste (also: essence)
- *Madhura*, *amla*, *lavaṇa*, *kaṭu*, *tikta*, *kaṣāya* — sweet, sour, salty, pungent, bitter, astringent

Flow

Warm-up (5 min)

Daily prompt + recall: dinacharya principle.

Core (25 min)

1. **The Six Tastes** (*rasa*):

Sanskrit	English	Examples	Dosha effect
Madhura	Sweet	Rice, milk, sugar, fruit	↓ Vāta, ↓ Pitta, ↑ Kapha
Amla	Sour	Citrus, yogurt, vinegar	↓ Vāta, ↑ Pitta, ↑ Kapha
Lavaṇa	Salty	Salt, sea vegetables	↓ Vāta, ↑ Pitta, ↑ Kapha
Kaṭu	Pungent	Chili, ginger, garlic	↑ Vāta, ↑ Pitta, ↓ Kapha
Tikta	Bitter	Bitter gourd, turmeric, neem	↑ Vāta, ↓ Pitta, ↓ Kapha
Kaṣāya	Astringent	Banana (unripe), pomegranate, beans	↑ Vāta, ↓ Pitta, ↓ Kapha

2. **The principle:** a balanced meal includes ALL six tastes. Traditional Indian thalis are designed this way — you’ll notice rice (sweet), pickle (sour/salty), chili (pungent), bitter gourd or fenugreek (bitter), and a pulse-based dish (astringent).

3. **Meal timing:**

- Largest meal at midday (Pitta peak — digestion strongest).
- Light dinner before sunset (ideally).
- No heavy meal close to bedtime.

4. **One food rule:** *Virrudha-ahāra* — incompatible food combinations. Classical examples:

- Milk + fish (heating + cooling combination).
- Milk + sour fruit (digestive disturbance).
- Honey heated above body temperature (changes its qualities).

Note: some virrudha-ahāra rules have modern evidence (e.g. some lactose-fruit-acid interactions); others are traditional with limited validation.

Activity (10 min) — Taste tour

If samples available: tiny sample of each taste, one at a time. Note the sensation. Note what dosha it would affect.

If no samples: students list 3 foods they ate in the last 24 hours and identify which tastes were present + missing.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- Preview Day 7: “Tomorrow — primary source. BG 6.17.”

Homework

- For tomorrow’s meals, count how many of the six tastes you include. Aim for at least 4.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Read about the six-taste theory in Caraka Saṃhitā Sūtra-sthāna chapter 26.

- **Tier down:** Memorise just 4 tastes (sweet, sour, salty, bitter).

Teacher notes

- Skip the taste samples if allergies are a concern.
- The “milk + fish” rule is famous; honest framing: some virrudha-ahāra has biochemical basis, some is traditional. Don’t overstate either way.

Citation(s) used

- Caraka Saṃhitā Sūtra-sthāna ch. 26 — Sharma (1981) translation.
- Wujastyk (2003) on the six tastes.

Day 7 — Primary Source: Bhagavad-gītā 6.17

Module: Ayurveda (Middle) · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

Students read BG 6.17 in IAST + translation, identify the five activities Krishna names as needing regulation, and connect each to a dinacharya practice.

Materials

- Printed handout: BG 6.17 (Sanskrit, IAST, word-by-word, translation, brief commentary)

Flow

Warm-up (5 min)

Daily prompt + recall: dinacharya practice they tried.

Reading (20 min)

yuktāhāra-vihārasya yukta-ceṣṭasya karmasu yukta-svapnāvabodhasya yogo bhavati duḥkha-hā — Bhagavad-gītā 6.17

Word-by-word:

Sanskrit	Gloss
yukta	regulated, balanced, joined
āhāra	food
vihārasya	of recreation, lifestyle (gen.)
yukta-ceṣṭasya	of regulated effort/activity (gen.)
karmasu	in work, actions (loc.)
yukta-svapna	regulated sleep
avabodhasya	of waking (gen.)
yogo	yoga, discipline

Sanskrit	Gloss
bhavati	becomes
duḥkha-hā	sorrow-destroying

Continuous translation: > “He who is regulated in eating and recreation, in his effort in work, in his sleep and waking — for him, yoga becomes the destroyer of sorrow.”

The five activities (10 min)

Krishna names FIVE activities that need regulation: 1. *Āhāra* — eating 2. *Vihāra* — recreation, lifestyle 3. *Ceṣṭā in karma* — effort in work 4. *Svapna* — sleep 5. *Avabodha* — waking

Now connect to dinacharya: - *Āhāra* → eating timing + six tastes (Day 6) - *Vihāra* → exercise (vyāyāma) + leisure - *Ceṣṭā in karma* → balanced effort, neither lazy nor over-exerted - *Svapna* → sleep by 10pm - *Avabodha* → waking before sunrise (brāhma muhūrta)

Note: the verse is from the *Bhagavad-gītā*, a philosophical-spiritual text. It frames regulated living as the foundation for *yoga* (the discipline of mind). Ayurveda picks up this same framework on the body-health side.

Discussion (8 min)

- Question: “Which of the five activities do you find HARDEST to regulate in your own life?”
- Take 4 student answers.

Wrap-up (2 min)

- Preview Day 8: “Tomorrow — start designing your own 7-day dinacharya.”

Homework

- Pick ONE of the five activities. Notice it tomorrow. Are you “yukta” (regulated) or out of balance?

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Read Bryant (2009) commentary on BG 6.17.
- **Tier down:** Memorise the 5 activities only.

Teacher notes

- BG is a religious text for many traditions. Honour that. Here we use it as a primary source for the lifestyle-regulation principle.
- The “yoga destroys sorrow” line is profound; let it land without over-interpretation.

Citation(s) used

- BG 6.17 — vidya-karana RAG cache day-04-dinacharya.json#chunks[0].
- Bryant (2009) for Sāṅkhya-Yoga commentary on BG.

Day 8 — Project Session 1: Design Your Dinacharya

Module: Ayurveda (Middle) · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

Each student drafts a 7-day dinacharya for themselves, with each practice paired to its Ayurvedic principle.

Materials

- Project brief + rubric
- Worksheet template

Flow

Warm-up (5 min)

Brief: today is design. Show rubric.

Core (35 min) — Design sprints

Sprint 1 (10 min) — Wake-to-school routine. - Wake time? - First glass of water? - Oral hygiene? - Exercise? - Breakfast?

Each item paired with its Ayurvedic principle.

Sprint 2 (10 min) — Midday routine. - Largest meal timing? - Activities during Pitta hours (10am–2pm)?

Sprint 3 (10 min) — Evening + sleep. - Dinner timing? - Pre-bed wind-down? - Sleep target?

Sprint 4 (5 min) — Realism check. - Are these times achievable for your actual school week? - If not, what's the MINIMUM viable change?

Wrap-up (5 min)

- Plan submitted at door.

Homework

- Try ONE day of your dinacharya tonight + tomorrow morning. Note what worked and what didn't.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Also design a “weekend” version + a “school holiday” version.
- **Tier down:** Pick 3 specific changes (not a full overhaul).

Teacher notes

- Realism is the #1 thing. A dinacharya that requires getting up at 4am won't be followed.

- Some students may push back on family meal times. Don't override the family; suggest small adjustments only.

Day 9 — Project Session 2: Test + Refine

Module: Ayurveda (Middle) · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

Each student refines their dinacharya based on yesterday's trial and prepares a 3-min presentation.

Materials

- In-progress dinacharya drafts

Flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Quick share: which dinacharya item went well last night? Which didn't?

Refine (15 min)

- Adjust the dinacharya based on yesterday's experience.
- Add a one-line justification per item (cite the principle).

Buddy rehearse (15 min)

Pairs. - 3-min presentation each: "My dinacharya — what, why, how I'll know it's working." - 2-min feedback.

Wrap-up (10 min)

- 3 students share one change they made.
- Final touches at home.

Homework

- Finalise dinacharya. Practise presentation once.

Day 10 — Final + Presentations

Module: Ayurveda (Middle) · **Time:** 60 min (extend if possible)

Learning objective

Students demonstrate mastery via summative quiz + 3-min dinacharya presentation.

Flow

Quiz (20 min)

20 marks. MC + short answer + BG 6.17 reading + open response.

Presentations (35 min)

- 3 min talk + 1 min Q&A per student.
- Teacher marks rubric in real time.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- Closing: “Pick the ONE dinacharya practice you’ll keep beyond this module.”
- Reflection slip.

Homework

- None. Module done.

Module 3 (Middle) — Formative Quizzes

Part A — Day 3 (5 Q, 5 min)

1.
(1) Define Āyurveda literally.
2.
(1) Define Swasthya.
3.
(1) Name the 3 doshas.
4.
(1) Which elements make up Pitta?
5.
(1) True or False: “Everyone has all three doshas.” (T/F)

Key

1. *āyu* (life) + *veda* (knowledge) = science of life.
2. *swa* (self) + *stha* (established) = wellbeing.
3. Vāta, Pitta, Kapha.
4. Fire + water.
- 5.

Part B — Day 5 (8 Q, 12 min)

1.
(1) Vāta is built from which elements?
- 2.

3. (1) Kapha is built from which elements?
4. (2) Name 4 of the 6 tastes (rasa) in Ayurveda.
5. (1) Brāhma muhūrta refers to what?
6. (1) Pitta is dominant during which hours roughly?
7. (1) Why is the largest meal recommended at midday?
8. (1) What is dinacharya?
8. (2) Short answer: distinguish prakṛti from vikṛti.

Key

1. Air + space. 2. Water + earth. 3. Any 4 of madhura, amla, lavaṇa, kaṭu, tikta, kaṣāya. 4. ~96 min before sunrise; the traditionally-recommended waking time. 5. 10am–2pm. 6. Digestive fire (Pitta) is at peak then. 7. Daily routine. 8. Prakṛti = the dosha constitution you're born with. Vikṛti = your current dosha state (which can be out of balance).

Module 3 (Middle) — Summative Quiz

Time: 20 min · **Marks:** 20 · **Closed notebook**

Name: _____ **Class:** _____

A — Multiple choice ($5 \times 1 = 5$)

1. Āyurveda means:
 - a) Ancient medicine b) Science of life c) Hindu wellness d) Yoga lifestyle
2. Pitta is built from which two elements?
 - a) Earth + water b) Air + space c) Fire + water d) Fire + air
3. The traditional time to wake (brāhma muhūrta) is:
 - a) Sunrise b) ~96 min before sunrise c) Noon d) Anytime
4. The largest meal is best at midday because:
 - a) Tradition b) Digestive fire (Pitta) is strongest then c) School lunch timing d) Kapha is depleted
5. The 5 activities in BG 6.17 are:
 - a) Eating, exercising, drinking, sleeping, praying
 - b) Eating, recreation, work, sleep, waking
 - c) Yoga, meditation, food, rest, work
 - d) Wind, fire, water, earth, space

B — Short (3 × 2 = 6)

6. Distinguish prakṛti from vikṛti.
7. Name the 6 tastes (rasa) in Ayurveda.
8. Name 3 dinacharya practices, each with its Ayurvedic principle.

C — Primary source (3)

9.
(3) BG 6.17: word-by-word translate *yukta-svapnāvabodhasya*.

D — Open response (6)

10.
(6) In 4–5 sentences, articulate one specific area where Ayurveda is well-suited AND one where modern medicine is essential. Use specific examples.

Key

1b. 2c. 3b. 4b. 5b. 6. Prakṛti = inborn constitution; vikṛti = current state. 7. madhura, amla, lavaṇa, kaṭu, tikta, kaṣāya. 8. Examples: wake before sunrise (aligns with body's natural alertness peak); largest meal at midday (digestive Pitta is strongest); sleep by 10pm (aligns with melatonin cycle). 9. yukta (regulated) + svapna (sleep) + avabodhasya (of waking, gen.) — “of regulated sleep and waking.” 10. Personal answer. Marked on: specificity (3), honest both-and framing (2), clarity (1).

Total: 20.

Homework

Homework — Module 3 (Middle)

Day	Task	Time
1 → 2	Notice: bedtime, dinner, mood. Take 3 lines of notes.	10 min
2 → 3	Notice: which dosha tendencies do you see in YOURSELF?	10 min
3 → 4	Look up ONE Ayurvedic recommendation for your dominant dosha.	15 min
4 → 5	Pick ONE dinacharya practice. Try it tomorrow.	5 min + practice
5 → 6	Submit project plan (your draft dinacharya).	20 min
6 → 7	Count tastes in your meals tomorrow. Aim for at least 4.	10 min

Day	Task	Time
7 → 8	Pick one of BG 6.17's 5 activities. Notice it tomorrow.	5 min + practice
8 → 9	Try ONE day of your dinacharya. Note what worked.	24 hr practice
9 → 10	Finalise + practise presentation.	20 min

Writing Prompts

Writing Prompts — Module 3 (Middle)

1. **(Day 1)** What was your impression of Ayurveda before this module? In 5 sentences, what changed?
2. **(Day 3)** After the self-assessment — do you agree with the result? Why or why not?
3. **(Day 4)** Pick one dinacharya practice. Describe what trying it for one day felt like.
4. **(Day 6)** Pick one of the 6 tastes. Describe a meal that's heavy in this taste and what dosha effect it would have.
5. **(Day 7)** BG 6.17 names 5 activities to regulate. Pick the one you find HARDEST. In 5 sentences, explain why.
6. **(Day 10)** Argue: should Ayurveda be taught in school PE / health class? Defend your position in 1 page.
7. **(Cross-disciplinary)** Modern circadian biology says daily rhythms matter for health. Dinacharya says the same. Are they the SAME insight or DIFFERENT? Defend in 1 paragraph.

Activity 01 — Design Your Dinacharya

Module: Ayurveda (Middle) · **Days:** 8 · **Time:** 30 min within Day 8

Goal

Each student drafts a personalised 7-day dinacharya with Ayurvedic justification per item.

Materials per student

- Worksheet (below)
- Pencil

Worksheet template

Name: _____

DAILY ROUTINE (Mon–Fri, school days):

| Time | Practice | Ayurvedic principle |

Wake ():				
Morning hygiene:				
Pre-school:				
Mid-morning meal:				
Midday meal:				
Afternoon:				
Dinner:				
Pre-bed wind-down:				
Sleep:				

WEEKEND DIFFERENCES (Sat/Sun):

REALISM CHECK:

- Is this achievable for my actual life? Y / N
 - If "N" on any item, what's a smaller version I can do?
-

Discussion (5 min)

- Whose dinacharya is the most ambitious? Whose is the most realistic?
- Which item was hardest to find a Ayurvedic principle for?

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Add a Ritucharya (seasonal routine) layer — what would change in summer vs. winter?
- **Tier down:** Pick 3 specific changes only.

Project Brief

Project Brief — Module 3 (Middle)

Type: Personal 7-day dinacharya + 3-min presentation • **Marks:** 20

What you'll do

Design a 7-day dinacharya for yourself. For each practice, write one line explaining the Ayurvedic principle. Then present it to the class in 3 minutes.

Required elements

1. **Weekday routine** — wake, morning, midday, evening, sleep.
2. **Weekend variation** — what's different on Sat/Sun.
3. **Ayurvedic principle** per item — why the tradition recommends it.
4. **Realism statement** — confirm this routine is actually achievable.
5. **One BG 6.17 citation** — connect one item to one of the five activities Krishna names.

Format

- 1-page worksheet (template provided).
- 3-min spoken presentation on Day 10.

Rubric (see `rubric.md`)

Practical realism (×2) · Ayurvedic principle accuracy (×1.5) · BG 6.17 connection (×1) · Personal honesty (×1) · Communication (×1).

Self-reflection (Day 10)

In 4 sentences: 1. What did you commit to changing? 2. What did you discover about your current routine? 3. What practice will you keep beyond this module?

Rubric

Rubric — Module 3 (Middle) Project

Project marks: 20 (+ summative 20 → 40 total).

Criterion	4	3	2	1	Weight
Practical realism	Achievable; though through for actual school week	Mostly realistic	Some unrealistic items	Unrealistic	× 2
Ayurvedic principle	Every item has a correct principle	Most items principled	Some items vague	Items unjustified	× 1.5
BG 6.17 connection	One item explicitly linked to BG 6.17 activity	Connection presented	Vague mention	Missing	× 1

Criterion	4	3	2	1	Weight
Personal honesty	y Honest about current routine + what they'll actually change	Mostly honest	Aspirational without honesty	Performative	× 1
Communication	Confident, audible, within time	Mostly clear	Some clarity issues	Hard to follow	× 1

Max raw: 26. Project score = (sum × weights) × 20/26.

Common deductions

- Recommending changes that medically risk a child with a known condition: -5 and intervention.
- “Wake at 4am” without realism note: -2.
- No BG 6.17 connection: -2.